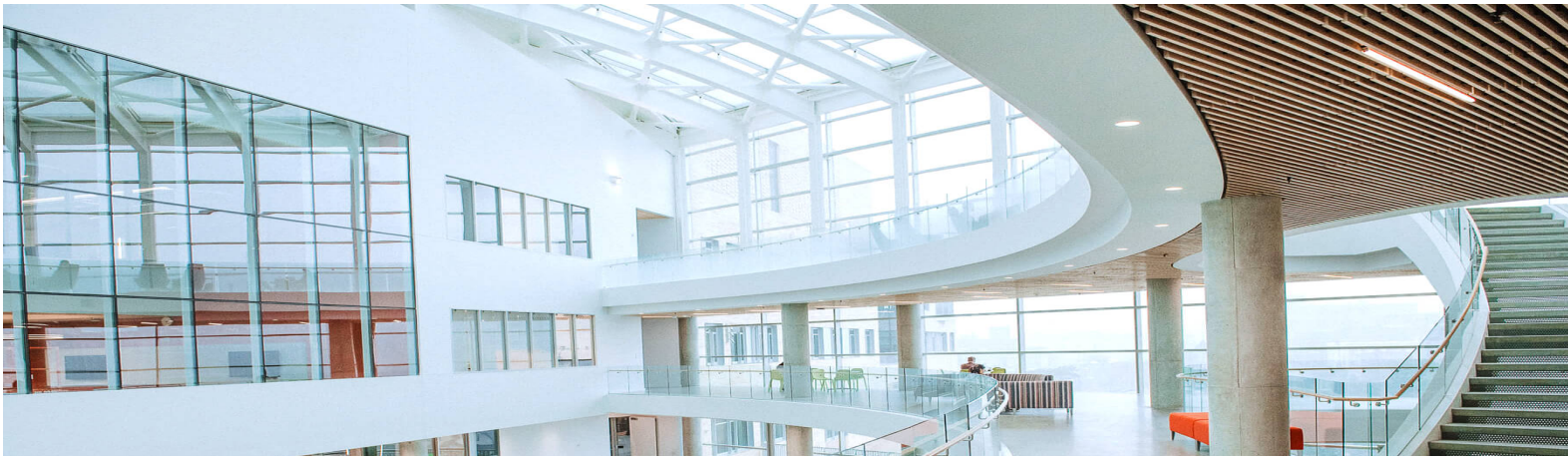




FORTUNA ADMISSIONS
INSIDER'S TOP TIPS
FOR APPLYING TO
CARNEGIE MELLON UNIVERSITY –
TEPPER SCHOOL OF BUSINESS

FORTUNA ADMISSIONS - INSIDER'S TOP TIPS FOR TEPPER

ABOUT THE SCHOOL

Tepper School of Business at Carnegie Mellon is one of the smallest among the top 20 business schools, boasting a close-knit culture and pioneering approach to management curriculum (a "management science" model over the case method, that's now integrated within all the leading business schools).

Tepper's central location within the Carnegie Mellon campus provides MBA candidates with access to the university's most sought after assets and networks. In 2018, the sparkling Tepper Quad made its debut: a physical space that functions as an innovation hub for the entire seven-college campus, reinforcing the university's focus on cross-pollination. This means Tepper MBAs are encouraged to collaborate with students from the six other schools including engineering, computer science, information technology, and design. Tepper is renowned for its focus on research and technology, so partnerships between other lauded centers on campus like AI, robotics and big data is at the center of its interdisciplinary approach.

Leadership and career development are at the heart of the program from day one, so students have ample opportunity to apply what they are learning in the classroom in real time. The Career Center staff is dedicated to the development and success of each student, holding 2,000 one-on-one coaching sessions each year. This commitment is often acknowledged by students and alumni when singing the praises of their alma mater.

STRENGTHS AND SPECIALIZATIONS

Technology, Analytics, Entrepreneurship, Energy and Organizational Behavior

INCOMING CLASS OF 2021

Number of Applicants: 1,307

Admissions Selectivity: 42%

Total Tuition: \$140,000

MBA Class Size: 200

Yield: 36.43%

POST-MBA CAREERS

Sector: Technology 30.5%; Consulting 30.5%; Finance 10.2%; Manufacturing 8.6%

Top Recruiters: Amazon, Microsoft, PwC, A.T. Kearney, Avant Energy, Bayer Corp., Deloitte

Avg. Base Salary: \$126,250

Employment in 3 months: 94%

MBA RANKINGS

	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019
BusinessWeek		11	-	10	18	15	14	12
Financial Times		16	19	18	17	16	17	19
Forbes	-	16	-	19	-	18	-	17
The Economist		12	14	16	19	22	21	26
US News	18	19	18	20	18	19	17	17

ADMISSIONS

Avg. Age: 28 yrs

Int'l Students: 35%

Avg. GMAT: 687

Female Students: 33%

Avg. GPA: 3.3

Deadlines for 2019-2020 *next page for covid-19 updates

Round 1: October 6, 2019

Round 3: March 2, 2020

Round 2: December 19, 2019

Round 4: April 9, 2020



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COVID-19 Changes to Admissions - updated 3/30/20, source: [Tepper website](#)

Round 3

No admissions changes; interviews will be hosted online.

Round 4*

Tepper is encouraging candidates to submit by the deadline, which can be submitted without exam scores. Your app will be processed then held until Tepper receives your GMAT/GRE/TOEFL test scores. You will receive a Round Four decision on May 21 if you submit an unofficial test score by May 10. If you are unable to meet the May 10 deadline, they will move your application into their Extended Rolling Round.

Extended Rolling Round

Typically, after Round Four has ended, CMU is still able to receive MBA applications until the end of June and provide decisions on a rolling basis. This year, Tepper will keep its application open as far into the summer as they can. If your application needs to move to or is submitted in the Extended Rolling Round, they will work with you to understand your plans and will be as flexible as possible.



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ESSAYS 2019-2020

Main Essay:

At Carnegie Mellon University's Tepper School, we value our community and it is important for each person to contribute to its success. What difference will you make as a member of the MBA class at the Tepper School? (Maximum 300 - 350 words, double spaced, 12-point font)

Optional Essay:

There also is an optional essay for additional information about your candidacy that you may wish to share with the admissions committee.

Use this essay to convey important information that you may not have otherwise been able to convey. This may include unexplained resume gaps, context for recommender selection, etc.

If you are a re-applicant, explain how your candidacy has strengthened since your last application.



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By Catherine Tuttle

Catherine brings deep MBA experience as a former Associate Director at Duke University's Fuqua School of Business. For five years she worked in the Career Management Center creating, implementing, and evaluating programs and coaching MBA's to achieve their career goals. She also served as the liaison to Admissions having worked with them earlier in her career as a Marketing Manager.

Tip #1 - Evidence of Impact

Impact on the bottom line, but also impact within your community. Tepper is guided by a mission to transform the world. They are looking for students who define community in the broadest sense of the word and have a desire to effect positive change. This theme is seen in the first essay option where they ask, "What difference will you make as a member of the MBA class at the Tepper School?" They want leaders who are functioning at a higher, more advanced level with a focus on something greater than themselves. Scanning through the list of 40+ clubs you'll find a wide variety of opportunities to give back while getting involved including Tepper Cares, Pro Bono Consulting, Net Impact, and Out & Allied. Think about where you've had an impact in the past and how that will translate on-campus.

Tip #2 - Demonstrate a growth mindset

Show an ability to learn from experience and those around you. Your ability to learn from mistakes and willingness to seek candid feedback from others demonstrates a desire to grow personally and professionally. The MBA experience is transformative in both of these areas – expect to push yourself and grow beyond what you imagined was possible. Tepper's focus on innovation and collaboration means they are looking for students who are adaptable, open to new ideas and coming from a variety of backgrounds, job experiences, and passions. When crafting your narrative, it's important to be clear about the strengths in your profile, but also the desire to learn from those around you.

Tip #3 - Know what inclusive community means

With a small class size of 200, Tepper students, faculty and staff place a high value on creating an inclusive, diverse and tight-knit community – one that's committed to making a positive impact on each other, business and the world. As such, the admissions team is looking for evidence of self-reflection and your ability to appreciate differences as a profound asset to a culture of innovation. In a statement to prospective students, the Executive Director of Community & Inclusion articulates, "We value each individual and acknowledge the intersectionality across the various dimensions of identity – who you are and how you define yourself. We strive to build an environment in which people can engage in and learn from each other's' differences and perspectives." This really speaks to the type of class that Tepper strives to craft, and a recognition of the diverse range of students who apply. Accept the challenge – and opportunity – to convey a deep level of introspection and purpose.

Tip #4 - Collaboration is the Key to Success

And not just collaboration within the MBA program, but across campus. This is why the Tepper Quad was opened in late 2018 with the vision of interconnecting all seven campus colleges. Ultimately, the goal was to create a space for the intersection of business, technology, and analytics. Students learn from each other alongside professors, entrepreneurs, designers, and computer scientists. When preparing your materials, you'll want to think about examples that show initiative and innovation, but also cross-functional collaboration, and global reach. Almost all schools would describe their culture as collaborative, but few take it as far.



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Tip #5 – Innovation is at the Heart of the Experience

Tepper sees itself as constantly moving forward with new ideas and creative approaches. Throughout your application (resume, essays, letters of recommendation, etc.) you want to showcase your ability to anticipate and resolve pressing problems. This is the focus of the first essay option: “personally or professionally, in what way have you been a pioneer?” In this essay and others, Admissions wants to see evidence of your initiative. What inspired you to take action? How did you rally others around your cause or overcome resistance to change? How did you bridge viewpoints from different stakeholders? What was the impact? Make sure to highlight your innovative spirit, your ability to set a strategic vision, and your collaborative approach to problem solving.

More about Fortuna Admissions:

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit [FortunaAdmissions.com](https://www.FortunaAdmissions.com)

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances for admission, reserve yours at [FortunaAdmissions.com](https://www.FortunaAdmissions.com)

